SLL-2 Ground & Match Services Agreement - Essex Farms (Draft)

Nov 8, 2026 · @Nikster

Drafting notes (remove before signing)

This is a first draft for counsel to review; it is not legal advice. Essex Farms provides a turnkey package for one fee per Match Day. The package covers the ground, a prepared pitch and outfield, and an umpire panel registered with the DDCA. It also covers scorers, match balls of an agreed brand and quality, ground staff, power, and floodlights whenever they are needed. Essex Farms also gives the permissions and space for the League's DRS setup. The League pays one invoice per weekend and holds back 10% until the season ends.

Season shape. 12 teams play in 2 groups of 6. Each group plays a single round-robin of 15 matches, so there are 30 league matches. Two semi-finals and the final follow, making **33 matches**. At three matches a day, that is 10 league Match Days, a semi-finals day and a final day: **12 Match Days**.

Open points

- [ ] Essex Farms' rates for Schedule 3.
- [ ] Service credits: amounts to be agreed and written into Schedule 4 before signing.
- [ ] Ball brand and model, to be agreed in writing (clause 3.4).
- [ ] A single round-robin is assumed in each group. If teams in a group play each other twice, there are 63 matches over 21 Match Days.
- [ ] Match referee: supplied by the League or by the Venue Provider (clause 3.2(e)).
- [ ] For counsel: Essex Farms' legal entity, address, GSTIN and authorised signatory; the League's details; stamp duty.

Ground and Match Services Agreement

This Agreement is made at New Delhi on [date] between:

1. **Playful Ventures Private Limited**, CIN [•], registered office [•], acting through [name, designation] (the **League**); and
2. **[Legal entity operating Essex Farms Cricket Club & Academy]**, [constitution], registered office [•], GSTIN [•], acting through [name, designation] (the **Venue Provider**), which operates the cricket ground known as Essex Farms Cricket Club &

Academy, near Shokeen International School, Chhawla, New Delhi 110071 (the **Ground**).

Recitals

A. The League organises the Shanti Devi Legends League, a corporate T20 league. Its second season (**SLL-2**) runs from 23 January to 14 March 2027.

B. The Venue Provider owns or lawfully controls the Ground. It has agreed to host every SLL-2 match there and to provide the match services in this Agreement for a fixed fee per match day.

1. Definitions

- **Match Day** means a day on which one or more SLL-2 matches are scheduled at the Ground, normally a Saturday or Sunday.
- **Reserved Days** means the days listed in Schedule 1 that the Venue Provider holds for the League. **Confirmed Match Days** are the Reserved Days the League confirms under clause 2.3.
- **Slots** means the three match slots on a Match Day, with reporting times of 8:00 AM, 11:30 AM and 3:00 PM IST (Rule 4.2), each match lasting about 3 hours 30 minutes.
- **Match Services** means the services in clause 3 and Schedule 2.
- **Rules** means the SLL-2 Rules & Regulations issued by the League (3 November 2026), as amended.
- **League Representative** means the person the League names in writing to act for it on Match Days, initially [name, mobile].
- **Fee** means the amounts in Schedule 3.

Season Matches means the 33 SLL-2 matches: 30 league matches (12 teams in two groups of six, each group playing a single round-robin of 15 matches), two semi-finals and the final, played over 12 Match Days.

2. Use of the Ground

2.1 The Venue Provider grants the League exclusive use of the Ground, its pavilion, dressing rooms and the facilities in Schedule 2, Part A. This runs on every Confirmed Match Day from **6:30 AM until one hour after the last match ends** (and no later than [11:00 PM]).

2.2 **Exclusive use: no other bookings on Match Days or Reserved Days.** This is an essential term of this Agreement.

- (a) On every Confirmed Match Day **and** every Reserved Day, the Ground and all its Slots are held exclusively for the League for the whole day. The Venue Provider shall not book, let, license or allow use of the Ground, any Slot, the nets next to the field of play, or the parking area by any other person for any match, practice, tournament, event or other purpose. This applies whether or not the League has yet confirmed that day.
- (b) A Reserved Day stops being held only if the League releases it in writing. Silence, delay or a missed confirmation by the League is not a release.
- (c) The Venue Provider shall not accept a provisional or conditional booking from anyone else for those days. It shall cancel, at its own cost and risk, any booking that already conflicts with them.
- (d) A breach of this clause is a material breach that cannot be remedied. The League may terminate under clause 7.6. The Venue Provider shall also reimburse the League's reasonable costs of rearranging the affected matches, including at another ground.

2.3 **Confirming days.** The League shall confirm the Match Days and the Slots used on each by [15 December 2026], after the SLL-2 auction, by sending the fixture list. It may change a Confirmed Match Day on 7 days' written notice without charge, at most [3] times in the season. It may also add Reserved Days for semi-finals, a final or a replayed match.

2.4 **Additional days.** The League may book extra days at the Ground (practice, trials, a media day) at the rate in Schedule 3, subject to availability.

2.5 **Access before the season.** The Venue Provider shall give the League and its vendors reasonable access, by appointment, to survey the Ground. This covers a broadcast survey, branding measurements and tent layout, and a test day for the live stream before the first Match Day.

2.6 **Condition.** The Venue Provider confirms that the Ground is a turf ground fit for T20 cricket under standard ICC playing conditions. It holds every licence, permission and approval needed to host the matches, spectators, broadcast and catering, and it will keep them valid throughout the season.

3. Match Services

The Venue Provider shall provide the following on every Confirmed Match Day, at its own cost and within the Fee. The service standards are in Schedule 4.

3.1 **Pitch and outfield.**

- (a) A prepared turf pitch fit for T20 cricket for each match. Pitches are rotated so that no pitch is used for more than [2] matches on one day.

- (b) The outfield mown and rolled, free of stones and hazards, with the 30-yard circle, creases and fielding markings freshly painted before the first match. Creases are re-marked and the pitch swept and rolled (light roller, up to 7 minutes) between matches.
- (c) A boundary of [60–65] metres from the centre of the pitch, marked by rope or cushions.
- (d) Covers for the pitch and square, and the staff and equipment to cover and dry the ground quickly when it rains (super-sopper or equivalent).
- (e) Sight-screens at both ends, three sets of stumps and bails (one in use, two spare), a drinks trolley, and a working rope or pole for every boundary.
- (f) Pitch preparation to begin at least [10] days before the first Match Day, with a pitch report to the League 48 hours before each Match Day.

3.2 **Umpires and match officials.**

- (a) Two on-field umpires for every match, plus one reserve (third) umpire for each Match Day who also handles DRS reviews when replay is available (Rule 10.4).
- (b) All umpires must come from the Venue Provider's panel of umpires registered with the Delhi & District Cricket Association (DDCA). They must know the Rules (including the Legend scoring in Rule 8, powerplays and the over-rate rules), and wear a uniform the League approves.
- (c) The Venue Provider shall send the League its umpire panel by [1 January 2027]. The League may reject any umpire on reasonable grounds, including any link to a franchise, owner or player. No umpire may stand in a match involving a team they have played for, owned or been paid by.
- (d) Umpires report 45 minutes before the first reporting time and stay until the last match's result is signed.
- (e) [The match referee is appointed by the League / is supplied by the Venue Provider: choose one.]

3.3 **Scorers.** One official scorer per match, scoring ball by ball live on the League's digital platform (Rule 1.7). Also one backup paper scorer per Match Day. The signed scorecard goes to the League Representative within 30 minutes of each match. Scorers shall follow the League's scoring guide for Legend runs and the Impact Player.

3.4 **Match balls.** The Venue Provider shall supply all match balls, as part of the Match Day fee.

- (a) White balls (Rule 1.2) of a brand, model and quality agreed in writing by the Parties before the first Match Day. The Venue Provider may not substitute another ball without the League's written consent.
- (b) Two new balls for every match, one per innings, opened in front of the umpires.

- (c) A box of used replacement balls of the agreed brand and similar wear on each Match Day, kept by the reserve umpire.
- (d) Enough stock at the Ground before the first Match Day, and through the season, that no match is delayed for want of a ball.
- (e) Used match balls belong to the League.

3.5 **Ground staff.** At least [4] ground staff, [2] ball boys and [2] housekeeping staff for the pavilion and washrooms throughout each Match Day. All of them wear identification and follow the League Representative's reasonable directions.

3.6 **Power and floodlights.** The Venue Provider shall provide mains power with a standby generator and enough diesel to run the broadcast, DRS, public address, tent and catering through every match without a break. It shall also provide **floodlights whenever required**: whenever natural light is not enough for safe play, as the umpires or the League Representative decide, including for any match that starts at or runs past 3:00 PM. Floodlights, generator and diesel are included in the Match Day fee. The floodlights shall be of a standard fit for T20 cricket and switched on before visibility drops.

3.7 **Venue coordinator.** One named person on site with authority to act for the Venue Provider, from 6:30 AM until the Ground is handed back. Named in Schedule 1.

3.8 **DRS setup.** Each team has DRS reviews under Rule 10.4. To make that possible, the Venue Provider shall, at no extra charge:

- (a) give the League and its broadcast and DRS vendors every permission needed to install DRS and replay equipment at the Ground. That includes camera towers or platforms at both ends and square of the wicket, stump or crease cameras if used, cabling routes and a satellite or internet uplink;
- (b) accommodate the setup: space for camera positions with clear sightlines, a lockable third-umpire room or booth with seating and power next to the scorer's box or pavilion, and a dedicated, earthed power supply backed by the generator;
- (c) allow access for installation and testing on [two] days before the first Match Day and before the first match of each Match Day, and secure overnight storage for equipment left at the Ground; and
- (d) not move, block or interfere with the DRS equipment, and keep ground staff and spectators clear of camera positions during play.

The League's vendors supply and operate the DRS equipment. The reserve umpire acts as third umpire.

4. The League's responsibilities

4.1 The League shall:

- (a) send the fixture list and Slots under clause 2.3, and any change as early as practicable;
- (b) organise the teams, players, match referee (if under clause 3.2(e)), broadcast, catering, tent and seating, public address, branding and the League's own match-day staff;
- (c) name a League Representative for each Match Day, who signs the match-day checklist in Schedule 4;
- (d) make sure its teams, vendors and guests follow the Ground's reasonable rules on safety, smoking, alcohol and restricted areas (Schedule 2, Part B), and use only the designated changing rooms (Rule 7.5); and
- (e) leave the Ground in the condition it was received, fair wear and tear excepted, and pay for damage caused by its teams, vendors or guests.

4.2 The League's on-field decisions (through its match referee and the Organising Committee) govern the cricket. The Venue Provider's staff shall not interfere with them.

5. Broadcast, branding and commercial rights

5.1 All broadcast, streaming, photography, video, data and ball-by-ball clip rights in SLL-2 matches belong to the League. The Venue Provider shall allow the League's broadcaster to set up camera positions, cabling, a commentary box and a production area as agreed in the venue survey (clause 2.5). It shall not record or stream matches itself.

5.2 On Confirmed Match Days the League has the exclusive right to branding at the Ground. That includes boundary boards, sight-screens, pitch-side wedges, the scorer's box, dugouts and entrances, and the stumps if the League supplies branded stumps. The Venue Provider shall cover or remove other third-party branding in the broadcast frame [except its own name board at the entrance].

5.3 The Venue Provider is named as **Venue Partner** of SLL-2 on the League's website, broadcast graphics and Venue Partner logo positions, as the League decides. The League may use the Ground's name, images and logo for that purpose during and after the season.

5.4 Catering, merchandise and hospitality on Confirmed Match Days are the League's. The Venue Provider may run its own canteen only with the League's prior consent, and it may not sell or advertise brands that compete with League sponsors.

6. Fees and payment

6.1 **Fee.** For each Confirmed Match Day the League shall pay the Match Day fee in Schedule 3. It covers everything in clauses 2 and 3: ground, umpires, scorers, ground staff, ball boys, housekeeping, match balls, power, generator and diesel, floodlights whenever

required, and the DRS permissions and accommodation in clause 3.8. In addition the League shall pay the one-time pitch and outfield preparation fee in Schedule 3. No other charge is payable unless the League has agreed it in writing in advance.

6.2 **Days not used.** No fee is payable for a Reserved Day that is not confirmed. If the League cancels a Confirmed Match Day with less than 7 days' notice, other than for weather or force majeure, it shall pay [•]% of the Match Day fee.

6.3 **Advance.** On signing, the League shall pay an advance of [10]% of the estimated season fee (Schedule 3). The advance is adjusted against the first invoices.

6.4 **Invoices.** The Venue Provider shall invoice after each weekend for the Confirmed Match Days played, with the signed match-day checklists (Schedule 4) attached. The League shall pay undisputed amounts within [15] days of receiving a valid GST tax invoice, by bank transfer only. No cash payments.

6.5 **Retention.** The League shall hold back 10% of each invoice. The retention is released within 30 days after the final match, once the Ground is handed back and all service credits have been settled.

6.6 **Service credits.** If a service falls short of the standard in Schedule 4, the League may deduct a service credit from the next invoice or from the retention. The amount of each service credit shall be agreed by the Parties and written into Schedule 4 before the first Match Day. Service credits are the League's main remedy for routine shortfalls, but they do not limit its rights for a serious or repeated failure (clause 7.6).

6.7 **Taxes.** Fees are exclusive of GST, which the League shall pay against a valid tax invoice. The League may deduct tax at source as required by law.

6.8 The Venue Provider is solely responsible for paying its own staff, umpires, scorers and suppliers, and for all statutory dues relating to them. Umpires and scorers shall not seek or accept any payment from franchises, owners or players.

7. Safety, risk, weather and termination

7.1 **Safety and medical.** The Venue Provider shall keep the Ground, stands, structures, electrical installations and washrooms safe and in good repair. It shall provide a first-aid room, a staff member trained in first aid on every Match Day, and a clear route for an ambulance to the field of play. The League arranges the ambulance and medical cover. The Venue Provider shall also provide fire extinguishers and keep emergency exits clear.

7.2 **Security.** The Venue Provider controls the Ground's gates and perimeter and keeps its property secure overnight, including any League equipment left at the Ground by agreement. The League provides event security inside the venue on Match Days.

7.3 **Insurance.** The Venue Provider shall hold public liability insurance of at least INR [•] for the Ground for the whole season, with the League named as an additional insured. It shall show proof before the first Match Day. The League shall hold [event / public liability] insurance for SLL-2 matches.

7.4 **Liability.** Each Party indemnifies the other against third-party claims for death, injury or damage to property caused by its own negligence or breach, or that of its staff and contractors. Apart from that indemnity, and except for fraud, neither Party is liable for indirect or consequential loss. Each Party's total liability is limited to the total season fee under this Agreement.

7.5 **Weather and an unfit ground.**

- (a) The umpires, with the match referee, decide whether play is possible (Rules 10.11 and 11). The Venue Provider shall use all its ground staff and equipment to get the Ground fit for play as fast as possible.
- (b) If no ball is bowled on a Confirmed Match Day because of weather, [•]% of the Match Day fee is payable. If any match starts, the full fee is payable.
- (c) If the Ground is unfit for a reason within the Venue Provider's control (pitch not prepared, covers not used, waterlogging, power failure, umpires absent), no fee is payable for the matches lost. The Venue Provider shall also give the League a replacement day at no charge and pay the service credits in Schedule 4.

7.6 **Termination by the League.** The League may terminate this Agreement by written notice if: (a) the Ground becomes unavailable or loses a licence it needs; (b) a critical failure (Schedule 4) occurs on two Match Days; (c) the Venue Provider breaches clause 2.2 (exclusive use) on any day; or (d) the Venue Provider commits any other material breach and does not remedy it within 3 days of notice. The League may then move the remaining matches to another ground. The Venue Provider shall reimburse the reasonable extra cost of that ground, up to INR [•], and the League may set it off against any amount due.

7.7 **Termination by the Venue Provider.** The Venue Provider may terminate only if an undisputed invoice remains unpaid 30 days after written notice. It shall not suspend services during the season while that notice runs.

7.8 **Force majeure.** Neither Party is liable for failure caused by events beyond its reasonable control, such as government orders, epidemics, civil unrest, national mourning or extreme weather beyond clause 7.5. The Parties shall reschedule affected Match Days in good faith, and no fee is payable for days not played.

8. Term, disputes and general

8.1 **Term.** This Agreement runs from signing until the retention is released after the SLL-2 final, unless terminated earlier. [Option: the Venue Provider grants the League a right of first refusal on the same dates for SLL-3, to be exercised by 30 June 2027.]

8.2 **Conduct and integrity.** The Venue Provider's staff, umpires and scorers shall not bet on, or help anyone bet on, SLL-2 matches. They shall not pass on match information for that purpose, or accept gifts from franchises, owners or players. Any breach is a material breach.

8.3 **Confidentiality.** Each Party keeps the terms of this Agreement and the other's non-public information confidential, except as required by law or to advisers.

8.4 **Disputes.** The League Representative and the venue coordinator settle match-day issues on the spot. Any other dispute goes first to a meeting between senior representatives within 7 days of a written request. If it is not resolved within 21 days, it shall be referred to a sole arbitrator under the Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996. The seat is New Delhi and the language English. The courts at New Delhi have exclusive jurisdiction.

8.5 **General.** This Agreement (with its Schedules) is the entire agreement on its subject. It may be changed only in writing signed by both Parties. Neither Party may assign it without the other's consent, except that the League may assign it to an affiliate or successor organiser of the league. Nothing in it creates a partnership or employment. Notices go by email to the addresses in Schedule 1, with a courier copy for breach or termination. It may be signed electronically and in counterparts. Stamp duty: [counsel].

Execution

For the League	For the Venue Provider
Playful Ventures Private Limited	**[Venue Provider]**
Name: [•]	Name: [•]
Designation: [•]	Designation: [•]
Signature: _____	Signature: _____
Date: [•]	Date: [•]

Witnesses: 1. [name, address, signature] · 2. [name, address, signature]

Schedule 1: Dates and contacts

Reserved Days: every Saturday and Sunday from 23 January to 14 March 2027, 16 days: 23–24 Jan, 30–31 Jan, 6–7 Feb, 13–14 Feb, 20–21 Feb, 27–28 Feb, 6–7 Mar, 13–14 Mar.

Season Matches: 12 teams in 2 groups of 6. Each group plays a single round-robin of 15 matches, giving 30 league matches; then 2 semi-finals and the final, **33 matches in all**. At three matches a day (reporting at 8:00 AM, 11:30 AM and 3:00 PM), the League expects to confirm **12 Match Days**: 10 league days, a semi-finals day (13 March) and the final (14 March).

Role	League	Venue Provider
Signatory	[•]	[•]
Match-day representative / venue coordinator	[name, mobile]	[name, mobile]
Accounts (invoices)	[email]	[email]

Schedule 2: Facilities and ground rules

Part A: Facilities on every Match Day

- Two dressing rooms with changing areas, one per team, plus a separate umpires' room
- Clean washrooms (men and women) with running water, and drinking water for players and staff
- Two covered dugouts with seating for at least [15] each
- A scorer's box with power and a table, and a commentary or production position for the broadcaster
- Parking for at least [•] cars, and access for the broadcast van, tent vendor and caterer
- Space next to the boundary for the League's tent, seating and catering ([•] square metres)
- A first-aid room, and an ambulance route to the field of play
- Mains power plus a standby generator; floodlights whenever required (clause 3.6); space, power and permissions for the DRS setup (clause 3.8)

Part B: Ground rules for the League's teams and vendors: [Venue Provider to list: smoking, alcohol, restricted areas, vehicle movement, waste disposal].

Schedule 3: Fees

Item	Unit	Rate (₹, before GST)
Match Day fee: ground hire, DDCA-registered umpires, scorers, ground staff, ball boys and housekeeping, match balls of the agreed brand, power, generator and diesel, floodlights whenever required, DRS permissions and accommodation	per Confirmed Match Day	[•]
Pitch and outfield preparation	one-time	[•]
Additional day (practice, trials, media)	per day	[•]

Agreed match ball: [brand, model], [quality or specification].

Schedule 4: Service standards and service credits

The League Representative and the venue coordinator complete and sign this checklist at the end of each Match Day. Service credit amounts are to be agreed before the first Match Day (clause 6.6). A **critical failure** is any venue-caused shortfall that stops a match starting within 30 minutes of its scheduled time, or causes it to be abandoned.

Service	Standard	Service credit if missed
Ground ready	Pitch, markings, boundary, sight-screens and stumps ready by 7:30 AM	[To be agreed]
Umpires	2 DDCA-registered on-field umpires per match and 1 reserve per day, on time and in uniform	[To be agreed]
Scorers	Every ball scored live on the League's platform; signed scorecard within 30 minutes	[To be agreed]
Match balls	2 new balls of the agreed brand per match, plus replacement balls on the day	[To be agreed]

Service	Standard	Service credit if missed
Power and floodlights	No outage longer than 10 minutes during a match; floodlights on whenever required	[To be agreed]
DRS	Permissions, space, power and access in place as in clause 3.8	[To be agreed]
Ground staff	At least 4 ground staff, 2 ball boys and 2 housekeeping staff	[To be agreed]
Washrooms and water	Clean and stocked throughout the day	[To be agreed]
Critical failure	None	No fee for the matches lost, plus [to be agreed]; counts towards termination (clause 7.6)